

Downing Blasts Key Miner Twinbill Sweep

Bob Downing smashed a pair of homers and Coach Andy Cohen got help from a 10th man (Cowboys) as University of Texas at El Paso's Miners swept a pair of collegiate baseball sets from New Mexico Highlands Thursday in Dudley Field.

The Miners overcame a 4-1 deficit in the first game and roared back for a 6-5 victory, then bombed the Cowboys in all but two innings for a 10-4 twilight win behind the superb hurling of Mike Kruta.

The wins pushed U.T. El Paso to a 5-3 mark on the 1974 season in preparation for Saturday's noon encounter hosting Oklahoma's strong Sooners in a single.

Downing poled his round-trippers in the second and third innings, scoring two off the second blast setting the tone for U.T. El Paso's best performance, run-wise, all year (11).

Coach Cohen singled out Downing's heavy stick and the relief pitching of Larry Richardson (starter Dave Jannusch went five) in the first game as outstanding efforts. "Dave really looked good in

there, but sort of ran out of gas," he said. Jannusch was tagged with five hits and four runs while sidelining two Cowboys.

Bob Whitney, tagged with the second-game loss for Highlands, gave the Miners all the help they needed in the big fifth inning. Mike Miller sailed one over the right field wall followed by Glenn Villarreal's triple. Downing followed with a single (scoring Villarreal) and Roy Stringer slammed one that almost reached the wall. Joe Pennies caught one of Whitney's first offers and sent it over the right field wall for the fourth run.

Cohen pointed out the barrage as outstanding, in that the trio are all switch-hitters.

Kruta went the route on the Miner-mound and earned Coach Cohen's praise for "real, strong pitching. Kruta gave up the four tallies on nine hits

while striking out two facing 29 batters.

Both clubs only committed one error each in the game.

Saturday's contest should provide a test for the Miners now that their team spirit is up after two wins.

The Sooners were fifth last year in the College World Series of Baseball and captured the Big Eight Conference. It's only the second game of the year for Oklahoma, with no reports on their progress thus far.

HIGHLANDS 220 000 1-5 7 1
EL PASO 013 010 1-6 9 2
Froio and Chubb; Jannusch, Richardson (fifth) and Brundage. W—Richardson, (1-0). L—Froio (0-1). HR—U.T. El Paso, Downing 2.

Second Game
HIGHLANDS 002 010 1-4 9 1
U.T. EL PASO 210 043 x-10 11 1
Borders.
Hickey (1), Whitney (5) and Tim Chubb; Kruta and Miller. W—Kruta (1-0). L—Whitney, (0-1). HR—U.T. El Paso, Nance, Mark Miller, Pennies.

DON'T MISS IT!

WHITEWALL